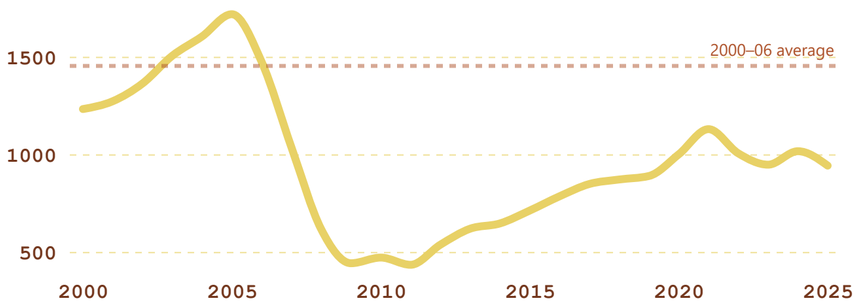
U.S. HOUSING AFFORDABILITY AFTER 2008 CRISIS | WHY YOUNG BUYERS ARE LOCKED OUT

Homebuilding Collapse 2005 - 2011	Income spent on mortgage (2023)	Payment rise due to rates (%)	Missing homeowners under 35 (millions)	Hawaii vs. West Virginia home prices
-74.7%	37.2%	80%	1.62	4.69

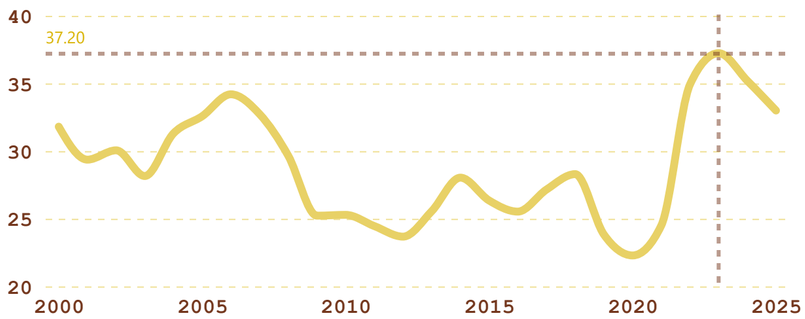
Homebuilding fell 75% and never recovered

Single-family housing starts, annual average (thousands), 2000–2025



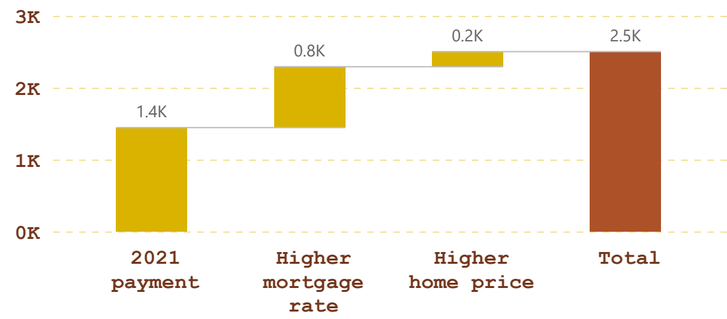
Mortgage payments hit 37% of income in 2023, the highest since 2000

Monthly payment on the median home as % of median income



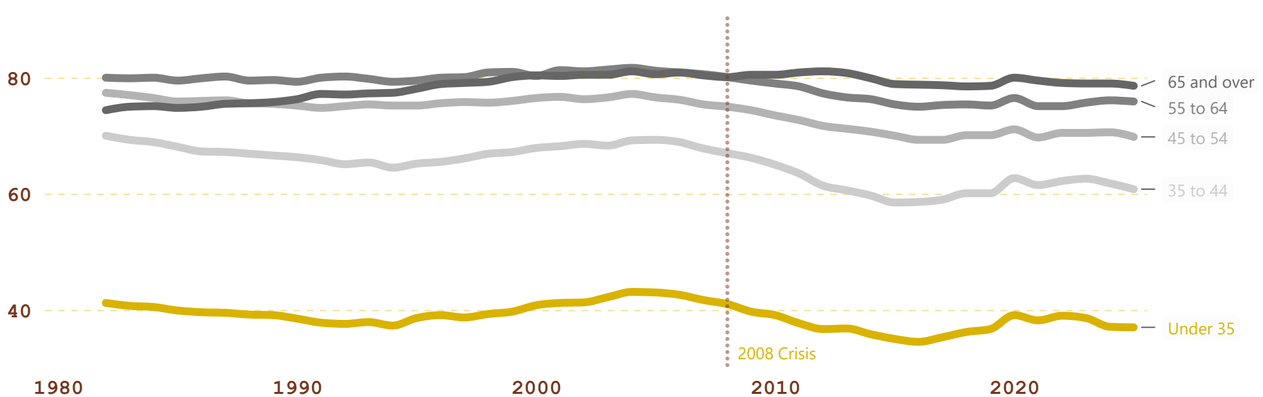
80% of the payment jump came from higher rates

$1,445 (2021) → $2,501 (2023): +$847 rates, +$210 prices



Under-35 ownership is still 6 points below its 2004 peak

Homeownership rate by age of householder (%), 2000–2025



Homes cost 4.7x more in Hawaii than in West Virginia

Typical home value by state, Zillow ZHVI, March 2026

